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EU AI Act

EU Database of
High-Risk AI Systems:
Deep Dive

October 2025

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Human resources and customer-facing functions concentrate the most high-risk incidents, while unclear classifications are widespread — only one incident is recorded as prohibited

appliedAI Initiative: AI Act: Risk Classification of AI Systems from a Practical Perspective (March 2023)

Enterprise Function	High-Risk	Unclear	Low-Risk	Prohibited	Total
Accounting and Finances	3	7	0	0	10
Purchasing	0	2	6	0	8
Research and Development	0	5	4	0	9
IT and Security	2	6	2	1	11
Customer Service	3	4	6	0	14
Logistics and Supply Chain	0	6	5	0	11
Marketing and Sales	0	1	13	0	14
Human Resources	9	1	0	0	10
Production and Manufacturing	0	5	4	0	9
Legal	1	5	4	0	10
Total	19	42	44	1	106

The forward-looking data indicates evolving priorities in enterprise AI incident monitoring, with people-centric accountability — especially Human Resources — remaining the most frequently reported source of high-risk systems (9 high-risk HR incidents). Across this single enterprise dataset there are 19 high-risk incidents out of 106 total (17.9%), which — if mapped one-to-one to AI systems — implies at least 19 AI systems would need to be registered in the database based on this example.

In contrast, a very large “Unclear” category (42 of 106 incidents, 39.6%) and 44 low-risk incidents (41.5%) point to blind spots that could raise the eventual registration count. If a portion of those 42 unclear events are reclassified as high-risk after review, the number of systems requiring registration could materially exceed the current 19-system floor.

These patterns suggest a pragmatic registration approach: treat 19 as the minimum immediate registration requirement for this enterprise, prioritise registration and review for HR (9), Customer Service (3), and Accounting & Finances (3), and urgently reclassify “Unclear” events so the database captures the true universe of high-risk AI systems.



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AI & Partners defends and extends the digital rights of users at risk around the world. By combining direct technical support, comprehensive policy engagement, global advocacy, grassroots professional services, regulatory interventions, and participating in industry groups such as AI Commons, we fight for fundamental rights in the artificial intelligence age.

This report was prepared by Sean Donald John Musch and Michael Charles Borrelli. For more information visit <https://www.ai-and-partners.com/>.

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Who Are We

AI That You Can Trust

Why Us?

Stay on the right side of history. At AI & Partners, we believe AI should unlock potential—not cause harm. We've seen the fear and fallout when teams lose control of AI, but also the trust and innovation that follow when it's handled responsibly. That's why we exist: to help you build AI you can trust and stand behind—for the long run.

80%

of AI systems
are unknown

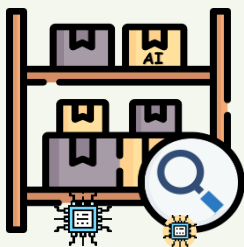
What Do We Do?

We enable safe AI usage—for your organization and your clients. Unknown AI adoption leads to confusion, risk, and reputational damage. We help you take control with tools to identify, monitor, and govern all AI systems—so you're not reacting to AI, you're leading it.

How Do We Do It?

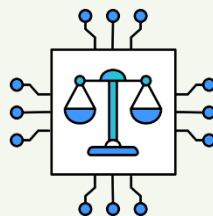
Do you know what AI systems you have? Identify all known and unknown AI systems (algorithms, LLMs, prompts, and models) from all internal and external AI vendors, automated by generating your inventory. Overall, 80% of AI inventory is unknown to our clients.

How do you guarantee ongoing safe AI use? Continuously monitor deployed AI systems for performance drift, anomalies or failures, real-world impacts, and emerging risks (e.g. data poisoning). Any malfunction of an AI system has severe implications for organisations (e.g. inability to assess online misinformation that leads to widespread public mistrust), so monitoring becomes a matter of urgency.



AI Discovery & AI Inventory

Automatically detect all AI systems, including models, algorithms, and prompts, and maintain a live, always-updated register for full visibility and compliance.



Responsible AI

Embed fairness, transparency, and control into every stage of AI use—aligning with the EU AI Act and building 'Trustworthy-by-Design'.



Model Monitoring

Continuously track your AI models after deployment to detect drift, bias, or failure—so you stay in control and prevent harm before it happens.





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Introduction

As the European Union's Artificial Intelligence Act (AI Act) moves closer to full implementation, the creation of the EU Database for High-Risk AI Systems plays a critical role in the regulation's framework. This centralized database will provide essential transparency, ensuring that both private and public sector AI systems are carefully monitored for compliance with the Act's stringent requirements. Managed by the European Commission, the database will offer visibility into AI systems' deployment, risk levels, and responsible entities, fostering accountability and public trust.

This report serves as a comprehensive guide to understanding the registration requirements, roles, and responsibilities within this framework, specifically focusing on the prohibited AI practices as outlined in the AI Act. It provides practical insights for AI developers, deployers, compliance officers, and policymakers, equipping them with the tools to navigate the complex landscape of high-risk AI. Through clear, actionable guidance on ensuring compliance, this report emphasizes the importance of a proactive approach to ethical AI deployment—ensuring systems adhere to safety, privacy, and anti-discrimination standards.



Best regards,

Sean Musch

Founder/CEO

AI & Partners



Key questions being asked about the EU Database



1. What is the EU Database for High-Risk AI Systems?

The EU Database for High-Risk AI Systems is a centralized registry that lists AI systems deemed to be high-risk under EU regulations. It aims to provide transparency and oversight by collecting and making public key information about these systems. The database includes details about the AI system's purpose, deployment, risk assessment, and responsible parties. Both high-risk and non-high-risk AI systems must be registered, with most information being publicly accessible, ensuring that regulators and the public can monitor the use and deployment of AI systems throughout the EU. This system is central to ensuring safe AI deployment across sectors.

2. Who is responsible for maintaining the EU AI Database?

The European Commission is responsible for overseeing and maintaining the EU AI Database. In collaboration with EU member states, the Commission ensures the proper functioning and continuous update of the database. They provide the technical and administrative support needed to manage the database, ensuring that it meets regulatory requirements. The Commission also consults with relevant experts to update and improve the database's functionality, ensuring that it remains an effective tool for regulating and monitoring AI systems. It is essential that the Commission manages this database to ensure consistency and reliability across the entire EU.

3. Who needs to register AI systems in the database?

Both AI system providers and public authorities deploying AI systems are required to register their AI systems in the EU database. Providers or their authorized representatives must submit the necessary data for high-risk AI systems, while public authorities deploying these systems must also register them. AI systems must be registered regardless of whether they are deemed high-risk or not, although high-risk AI systems have stricter registration and data requirements. This ensures that both the private sector and government entities are transparent about the AI systems they use, allowing regulators and the public to track their usage.

4. What information is required to be submitted when registering AI systems?

When registering AI systems, providers and deployers must submit detailed information that includes the AI system's purpose, technical specifications, risk assessment, and information about the parties responsible for its development or deployment. High-risk AI systems require more detailed risk analysis and monitoring plans. The registration also includes contact details for individuals responsible for managing or overseeing the system. This transparency allows regulatory bodies and the public to understand the system's function, potential risks, and the entities accountable for its development and use. It also helps ensure compliance with EU regulations on safety and ethical use.

5. How is personal data handled in the EU AI Database?

Personal data in the EU AI Database is strictly limited to what is necessary for the operation of the system. This includes contact information of those responsible for the AI system, such as the individuals in charge of registration. The regulation ensures that only essential data is collected, in line with data protection laws like the GDPR. Sensitive data not required for registration or oversight is excluded from the database. The system aims to strike a balance between maintaining transparency and protecting personal privacy, ensuring that personal data is used responsibly and only for regulatory purposes.





6. How will the database affect transparency and accountability in AI?

The EU AI Database enhances transparency by making crucial information about high-risk AI systems publicly accessible. This transparency allows consumers, regulators, and other stakeholders to understand how AI is being deployed, what risks are associated with it, and who is responsible for managing these systems. It fosters accountability by ensuring that AI providers and deployers are held responsible for their systems' impact. Public access to this information also allows for independent oversight, reducing the chances of misuse or unethical deployment. This level of transparency and accountability is essential for fostering trust in AI technologies across the EU.

7. Will the public have full access to all AI system data in the database?

While the majority of the information in the EU AI Database will be publicly accessible, some data will be restricted for specific reasons. Certain sensitive details, such as proprietary information or strategic business data, may be excluded from public access. However, the information available to the public will still provide a comprehensive understanding of the AI systems' purpose, risks, and the parties responsible for their deployment. For data that is restricted, only market surveillance authorities and the European Commission will have access, unless the AI provider gives consent for broader access. This ensures protection of both privacy and business interests.

8. How often will the EU AI Database be updated?

The EU AI Database will be updated regularly to reflect the latest developments in AI system deployments and regulatory compliance. Providers and deployers are required to update their system entries whenever there are significant changes, such as upgrades, new risk assessments, or modifications in the responsible parties. The European Commission will also periodically review the database to ensure it remains accurate, user-friendly, and compliant with evolving regulations. The frequency of these updates ensures that the database provides real-time or near-real-time information about AI systems, maintaining its relevance and effectiveness as a regulatory tool.

9. What are the consequences of not registering AI systems in the database?

Failure to register AI systems in the EU database can lead to severe consequences, including legal penalties and restrictions on market access. Non-compliance with the registration requirements can result in fines or sanctions imposed by EU regulatory bodies. Additionally, companies or public authorities that fail to register may be unable to deploy AI systems in the EU market, as these systems would be deemed non-compliant with EU regulations. This lack of transparency could also harm a company's reputation, undermining public trust and potentially limiting business opportunities. Therefore, timely and accurate registration is essential for legal and operational success in the EU.

10. How can businesses and public authorities seek support for database registration?

Businesses and public authorities can seek support from the European Commission for any technical or administrative issues related to registering AI systems in the database. The Commission provides comprehensive guidance, including detailed instructions on how to navigate the registration process, what information is required, and how to comply with data protection rules. Additionally, businesses can consult with regulatory bodies and experts within their respective countries for localized support. By leveraging the support provided by the Commission and local authorities, organizations can ensure that their AI systems are registered accurately and in accordance with EU regulations.





Understanding the EU Database



1. Establishment of the EU Database



What is this?

- The EU Database for High-Risk AI Systems is a digital registry that lists AI systems considered high-risk or non-high-risk under EU regulations.
- It includes key information about AI systems, such as their purpose, risk level, and the entities responsible for their deployment.

How is it relevant?

- This database ensures transparency and accountability, offering an easily accessible resource for both the public and regulators to monitor AI systems in use.
- It also ensures that businesses and public authorities adhere to strict registration standards for high-risk AI, promoting responsible deployment.

Why does it matter?

- The database helps protect citizens from harm by enabling regulatory bodies to ensure AI systems comply with safety, ethical, and legal standards.
- Public accessibility ensures that AI is deployed responsibly, encouraging more ethical innovation and allowing citizens to make informed decisions about the technologies influencing their lives.



2. Data Entry by Providers and Representatives



What is this?

- Data entry by AI providers or their representatives refers to the requirement for companies or organizations that create high-risk AI systems to submit detailed information into the EU database.
- This includes technical descriptions, risk assessments, and the responsible parties' contact details, ensuring full transparency about the systems.

How is it relevant?

- This is crucial for ensuring accountability and transparency.
- By requiring that AI providers submit comprehensive data, the regulation provides a clear picture of the systems in use.
- It helps authorities, consumers, and other stakeholders assess potential risks and address any concerns related to safety or fairness.

Why does it matter?

- This process ensures that businesses cannot deploy AI systems without scrutiny.
- It fosters an environment of compliance and transparency, holding companies accountable for their AI's performance and impact on users, particularly in high-risk sectors like healthcare, transportation, or law enforcement, where failures can have severe consequences.



3. Data Entry by Public Authority Deployers



What is this?

- Public authorities, including government agencies, must also enter AI systems they deploy into the EU database.
- This includes systems used in public services like policing, education, healthcare, or welfare, with a focus on transparency in their deployment and usage.

How is it relevant?

- This regulation ensures that public sector AI systems are subject to the same level of oversight and transparency as those in the private sector.
- Governments, being large deployers of AI in critical areas, must register these systems, ensuring they meet legal and ethical standards.

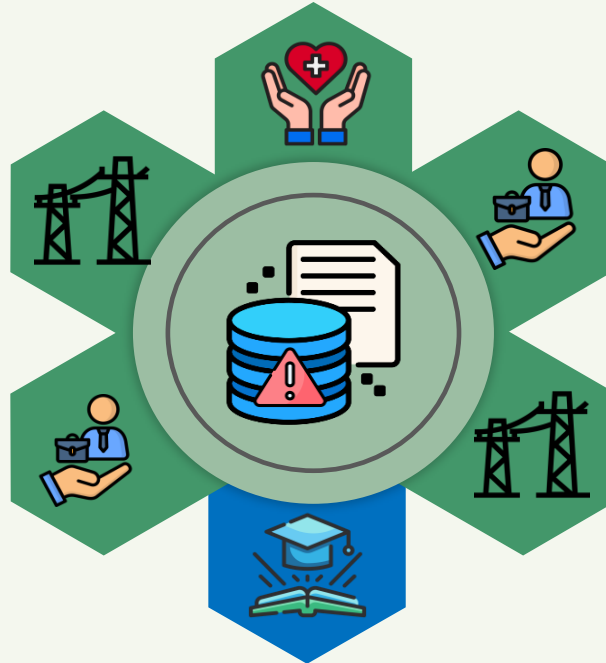
Why does it matter?

- Government use of AI can have far-reaching effects on citizens, particularly vulnerable groups.
- By requiring public authorities to register AI systems, the regulation prevents misuse or deployment of unethical AI systems, ensuring fairness, accountability, and protection of civil rights in public sector operations.





4. Public Accessibility and Exceptions



What is this?

- The EU database ensures that most of the information about AI systems is publicly accessible, though certain sensitive details may be restricted.
- The database is designed to be user-friendly, with most of the information being machine-readable and easily navigable.

How is it relevant?

- This transparency is critical for building public trust in AI technologies.
- It allows citizens, businesses, and watchdog organizations to access information about AI systems and their impact, creating an environment where the public can actively participate in discussions about AI's role in society.

Why does it matter?

- Public access ensures that AI technologies are held to account, particularly for systems that might affect people's daily lives.
- It reduces the risk of hidden abuses or unethical practices and enables individuals and organizations to advocate for the responsible use of AI in public and private sectors.
- It helps maintain democratic oversight in the digital age.





5. Use of Personal Data



What is this?

- Personal data collected within the EU AI database is strictly limited to what is necessary for registration, such as contact information of those responsible for AI systems.
- This ensures that only essential personal data is processed, in compliance with EU privacy laws.

How is it relevant?

- The regulation strikes a balance between transparency and privacy.
- By ensuring that only necessary personal data is collected, it protects individuals' privacy while maintaining sufficient information for regulatory oversight and accountability.
- This is particularly important for maintaining trust in AI systems across Europe.

Why does it matter?

- It matters because the protection of personal data is fundamental to maintaining trust in AI systems.
- Excessive data collection can lead to privacy violations, exploitation, and misuse of sensitive information.
- By limiting personal data use, the regulation fosters confidence in AI technologies while respecting individual rights.





6. Commission Responsibility and Support



What is this?

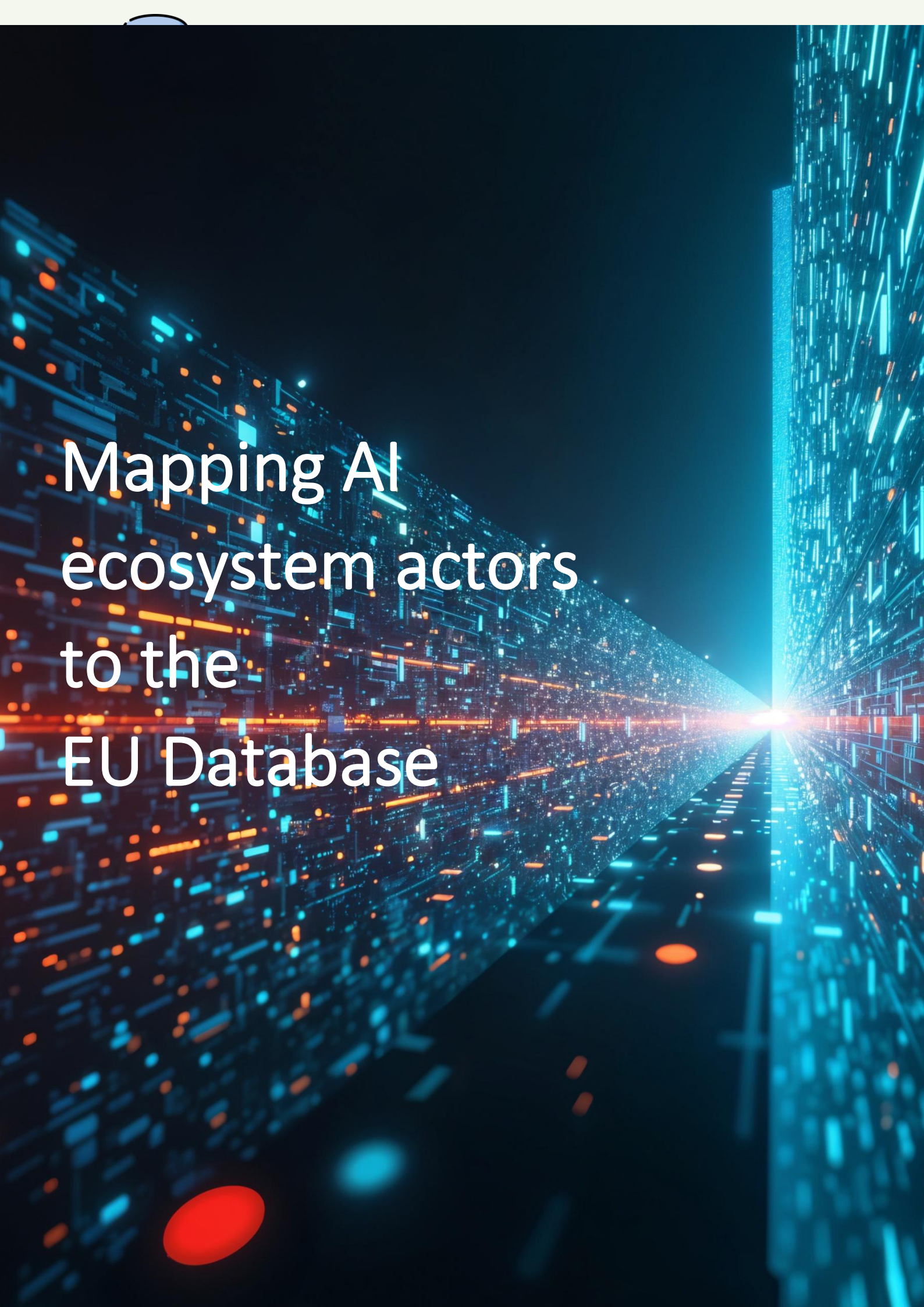
- The European Commission serves as the data controller, overseeing the management and operation of the database.
- The Commission ensures the database meets accessibility standards, promoting ease of use and ensuring it's functional for all users, regardless of ability or access to technology, fostering inclusivity.

How is it relevant?

- This role ensures the registration system operates smoothly by providing oversight and structure.
- The Commission's support guarantees that all providers and deployers can navigate the registration system successfully, reducing potential barriers to compliance and ensuring a user-friendly experience that aligns with regulatory standards.

Why does it matter?

- As a result of managing and supporting the database, the Commission plays a critical role in ensuring the regulation's effectiveness.
- Their responsibility ensures that AI systems are monitored and comply with EU laws, which protects citizens from potential harm, promotes ethical practices in AI deployment, and helps prevent abuses or risks arising from unregulated technologies.



Mapping AI ecosystem actors to the EU Database



EU Database		AI Ecosystem Actors					
Section	Description	Consumers	Workers	Business	Government	Minorities	General Public
Establishment of the EU Database	The European Commission, in cooperation with member states, will create and maintain a centralized EU database for AI systems. This includes both high-risk AI systems listed in Annex III and those deemed non-high-risk. Functional specifications will be shaped through expert consultation and updates managed collaboratively.	The establishment of a centralized EU database allows consumers to access essential information about AI systems they may use or be impacted by, especially those considered high-risk. This transparency empowers individuals to make informed decisions, particularly when engaging with services like healthcare, finance, or legal advice powered by AI. Knowing an AI system is registered and reviewed provides assurance of oversight. It builds trust in AI products and enables consumers to raise concerns when	The central EU database provides workers with an accessible resource to check whether AI systems used in their employment context are registered and recognized as high-risk. This could include systems used in recruitment, performance management, or workplace surveillance. Workers benefit from increased visibility into the tools used to make decisions affecting their livelihoods. This database helps protect against opaque or unregulated AI use and enables workers and unions to challenge potentially unfair	Businesses face new compliance responsibilities as the EU establishes this database. Providers of AI systems must ensure their products are registered appropriately, with correct categorization of risk levels. This can increase administrative work and may require dedicated legal or regulatory teams. However, it also creates an opportunity: registration offers legitimacy and may enhance customer and stakeholder trust. Transparent participation in the database could provide a competitive advantage. Companies not	Governments are deeply involved in creating, maintaining, and governing the EU database. Member states must work with the European Commission to ensure the database functions properly and meets technical and legal standards. Governments also serve as deployers of AI in public services and must ensure compliance with registration requirements. The database becomes a key tool for public accountability and regulation enforcement. By participating in its development, governments can shape how AI oversight evolves across Europe. It	For minorities, the creation of a public EU AI database is a step toward addressing bias and inequity in AI systems. By requiring disclosure of high-risk AI systems, especially those used in decision-making contexts like policing, education, or employment, the database enables marginalized groups to track and challenge discriminatory technologies. Civil society organizations can use the database to identify systems with potential for harm and advocate for reform. The visibility and structure of the database encourage	The general public gains a robust mechanism for AI transparency through the EU database. Citizens can see which AI systems are considered high-risk, who developed them, and where they are deployed, creating a more informed society. This improves digital literacy and encourages public debate around the ethics and risks of AI technologies. The database also serves as a check against unregulated or harmful uses of AI, helping foster public trust. As AI becomes more pervasive, a shared repository of system information promotes



		systems malfunction or show bias. As more systems are documented, consumers will better understand how AI is integrated into daily life and which systems require scrutiny.	systems. It encourages employers to be transparent and proactive, fostering more equitable work environments and supporting worker rights as AI becomes more embedded in business operations.	prepared to comply may face legal or reputational risk. Long term, the database could drive higher standards across the industry, rewarding ethical AI development and encouraging more responsible innovation.	also supports inter-agency cooperation, enabling authorities to monitor, audit, and improve AI use, both in the private and public sector.	developers to consider ethical implications more seriously. In effect, the system offers minorities a new tool for digital rights and social justice.	collective understanding and democratic oversight, reinforcing EU values around human rights, fairness, and accountability in technology.
Data Entry by Providers and Representatives	AI providers or their authorized representatives must enter the required data from Sections A and B of Annex VIII into the database. This ensures that detailed, standardized information on AI systems is collected at the source, supporting oversight and public accountability.	Consumers benefit when AI providers are legally required to input detailed, accurate information into the EU database. Knowing that providers must formally register high-risk systems increases consumer trust in AI products and services. Consumers can verify whether AI systems comply with regulations and assess how responsibly companies handle	Workers gain protections through mandatory data entry by providers, as this ensures that AI systems used in employment contexts are documented and can be scrutinized. For instance, AI tools managing hiring or monitoring workplace productivity must be recorded, allowing workers to verify their legitimacy. This	Businesses, especially AI providers, face a significant compliance obligation under the mandatory data entry rules. They must register their systems with detailed, standardized information, increasing administrative overhead. However, this formal process also provides an opportunity to demonstrate compliance,	Governments, as regulators and deployers of AI, must monitor provider compliance with data entry obligations. Regulatory agencies will oversee whether companies accurately register AI systems, ensuring that safety, privacy, and anti-discrimination standards are met. Governments may also use database information to	For minorities, mandatory data entry by AI providers is critical. It ensures early visibility into potentially harmful systems that could entrench discrimination in areas like housing, hiring, credit scoring, and policing. Registered information gives advocacy groups tools to analyze system risks and advocate for marginalized	The general public benefits from providers being mandated to register AI systems because it prevents hidden, unchecked deployments of influential technologies. Accessible information allows citizens, researchers, journalists, and civil society organizations to hold technology companies accountable. This strengthens public



		AI development. This transparency allows consumers to make better decisions, particularly when choosing products that might affect privacy, financial stability, or health. It also gives them a pathway to challenge companies that fail to meet disclosure obligations, reinforcing their rights in a market increasingly dominated by AI technologies.	reduces the risk of companies deploying untested, biased, or exploitative AI technologies without oversight. Workers and labor unions can use database entries to advocate for transparency, fair practices, and to challenge discriminatory AI-driven decisions. This requirement promotes safer, more ethical AI deployment in employment, strengthening worker rights and boosting organizational accountability.	responsibility, and quality, which can enhance market reputation. Transparent registration can become a mark of trustworthiness, creating competitive differentiation. Non-compliance risks penalties and reputational damage. Furthermore, smaller businesses may face challenges in dedicating resources to meet data-entry demands, prompting industry adjustments. Overall, mandatory entry fosters a healthier market where ethical practices and innovation are more closely aligned.	inform policymaking, market analysis, and enforcement actions. By requiring providers to submit data, governments create a verifiable record that can be used to audit, investigate, or recall problematic AI systems if necessary. This structured entry process strengthens governmental capacity to manage AI risks proactively and ensures that both public and private sectors are held accountable.	groups before harm occurs. It also creates a basis for legal action if AI systems violate anti-discrimination laws. Without this requirement, systemic biases could proliferate unchecked. By making providers responsible for transparency from the start, the regulation begins to close historical gaps where minorities bore disproportionate harm from opaque technological systems.	trust in AI, enabling more informed participation in discussions about digital rights, innovation, and ethics. The ability to review provider-submitted data empowers collective oversight, helping ensure AI advances serve the public interest rather than corporate secrecy. Over time, this transparency requirement promotes better standards across the tech industry and fosters an AI environment more aligned with democratic values.
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Data Entry by Public Authority Deployers	Public authorities deploying AI systems must enter information from Section C of Annex VIII. This applies to public sector use of high-risk AI, ensuring transparency in government deployments and compliance with the relevant legal provisions under Article 49(3) and (4).	When public authorities are required to register AI systems they deploy, consumers benefit through improved transparency and accountability in public services. Whether it's welfare allocation, public healthcare diagnostics, or legal risk assessment tools, individuals gain insight into how government decisions are being influenced by AI. This promotes fairness and builds trust in digital public services. Consumers can track which systems are in use and evaluate whether these tools respect their rights. If a system causes harm or produces biased outcomes, the	Workers employed by public institutions — or those affected by AI used in public service delivery — benefit from this section, as it mandates disclosure of governmental AI use. It ensures systems like staff scheduling tools or AI-driven evaluations in education or healthcare are registered and transparent. Workers can better understand how such systems impact their roles and advocate for fair implementation. Union representatives, policy watchdogs, and labor activists can also use this data to monitor trends and push back against	Businesses supplying AI systems to public sector clients are indirectly affected, as their solutions must be registered by the deployer. This adds pressure to ensure their products meet ethical and regulatory standards. Knowing that public agencies must log usage can prompt businesses to build compliance-ready, high-transparency systems. Public registration could also serve as a showcase, increasing credibility and aiding in future contracts. On the other hand, suppliers may face heightened scrutiny if their tools underperform or cause harm,	Governments are directly responsible for ensuring that any high-risk AI systems they deploy are properly registered. This builds internal accountability and requires coordination among agencies, technical staff, and legal teams. The regulation compels governments to examine the ethical and legal implications of AI deployments before implementation. It also deters misuse and forces reflection on whether AI should be used in certain contexts at all. Registration becomes a governance tool, enabling traceability and	Mandatory data entry by public deployers is particularly impactful for minorities, who are often disproportionately affected by algorithmic decision-making in law enforcement, immigration, education, and welfare. Public registration makes it possible to track the use of potentially biased or discriminatory systems and challenge them. Civil rights groups and advocacy organizations can use the data to flag harmful trends, pressure for audits, or pursue legal action. It ensures that state-sponsored AI systems don't operate without scrutiny. This layer	The general public gains greater confidence in government use of AI through this requirement. By mandating that authorities log AI deployments, citizens are offered a rare window into public sector digitization. The data helps demystify how decisions are made, particularly in critical areas like policing, social services, and taxation. It allows media, watchdogs, and citizens to monitor how automation is shaping governance. This fosters informed debate, civic engagement, and more equitable policy development. It also serves as a safeguard against
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		database allows consumers to seek recourse or push for changes, ensuring AI doesn't operate behind closed bureaucratic doors.	potentially exploitative or dehumanizing practices. The database protects workers from becoming invisible data points in opaque government automation.	especially in socially sensitive sectors. Overall, the requirement encourages higher accountability throughout the public AI supply chain.	oversight, while providing assurance to the public that AI use is monitored and documented. Ultimately, it drives more thoughtful, transparent use of AI in public service delivery.	of transparency is crucial for defending minority rights, ensuring fairness in public services, and preventing automated forms of systemic discrimination.	overreach, helping ensure public power mediated through AI remains answerable to the people it serves.
Public Accessibility and Exceptions	Most database content will be publicly accessible in a user-friendly, machine-readable format. However, certain sections—such as confidential provider data—will be restricted to authorities unless explicit consent for public access is granted, maintaining a balance between transparency and data protection.	Public access to most parts of the AI database empowers consumers to explore which systems are in use, by whom, and for what purposes. This helps them make informed choices when engaging with AI-driven services, especially those affecting finance, healthcare, or digital platforms. Accessible, machine-readable data means consumers don't need to be experts to understand	For workers, public accessibility to AI system data allows deeper insight into technologies influencing hiring, evaluation, and even termination processes. It supports efforts by unions, labor advocates, and employees themselves to identify questionable tools, especially those that operate without explicit consent or awareness. If certain workplace systems are	Businesses benefit from clear guidelines on what information is public versus protected. Public access offers legitimacy for compliant companies, helping them showcase their responsible AI practices and enhance brand reputation. Companies can point to their database entries as evidence of transparency. At the same time, the ability to keep sensitive details	Governments are tasked with managing the balance between transparency and security when making database entries public. While they must ensure that most AI systems, especially those used in public services, are accessible for public scrutiny, they must also protect sensitive systems (e.g., in law enforcement or national security). The challenge lies in maintaining public	Public access is a critical tool for minorities and advocacy organizations to detect and challenge discriminatory AI systems. Full visibility into how AI is used in sensitive sectors—such as education, policing, or immigration—enables community-led oversight. However, any limitations on disclosure could make it harder to uncover harmful patterns or biased	For the general public, user-friendly and transparent access to the AI database strengthens democratic participation in digital oversight. Citizens can independently explore how AI systems are being used, where risks lie, and who is responsible. This encourages informed public debate on data ethics, privacy, and automation. Exceptions for sensitive data are understandable



		what AI tools might influence their lives. However, exceptions for non-disclosed information may limit full transparency in some areas. Still, the balance ensures privacy where needed while equipping consumers with crucial tools to assess AI safety, legitimacy, and potential personal impacts.	concealed under exceptions, that could pose a barrier—but in general, the regulation’s emphasis on user-friendly, public access empowers workplace advocacy. It levels the playing field between employees and employers when AI is in use, promoting ethical labor practices and accountability in algorithmic management and human resources tech.	confidential (unless consent is given) protects trade secrets and competitive advantage. Striking this balance ensures innovation isn't stifled by over-disclosure. However, companies must be careful to avoid appearing secretive, especially if withholding information becomes controversial. Navigating these disclosure boundaries becomes a strategic part of corporate communication and compliance.	trust while ensuring operational integrity. Public access increases the pressure to use AI responsibly and ethically. Authorities must also manage public feedback and ensure the database’s usability, as poor accessibility could lead to mistrust or ineffective oversight. Transparency becomes a pillar of democratic governance.	tools. Accessible, machine-readable data makes it easier for legal teams, researchers, and activists to analyze trends affecting marginalized groups. The ability to scrutinize AI used by both corporations and governments becomes a powerful mechanism for advancing civil rights, ensuring AI does not replicate or exacerbate structural inequality.	but may raise concerns about overreach if used too broadly. Ultimately, the regulation seeks to empower the public with oversight while balancing safety and confidentiality. It promotes a culture of openness and civic engagement in the governance of emerging technologies.
Use of Personal Data	Only essential personal data will be collected for registration purposes, specifically for contact and legal	For consumers, the collection of personal data in the EU AI database is limited to what is necessary for registration,	Workers are directly impacted by the collection of personal data in the database, as the contact details of responsible	For businesses, the regulation requires that they provide only essential personal data, such as contact	Governments must be cautious when handling personal data in the AI registration process, as they are responsible for	For minorities, the use of personal data is a double-edged sword. While necessary data collection is essential for	For the general public, the database’s regulation ensures that personal data is handled with care, only



	representation. This includes names and contact details of responsible individuals. The regulation limits data use to operational necessity, aligning with EU data protection principles.	ensuring privacy protections are in place. This creates a sense of security that their personal information won't be misused or unnecessarily shared. Knowing that only essential data, such as contact details for those responsible for the system, is stored helps build trust in the database. Consumers can be confident that their data won't be exploited for marketing or other purposes. This careful balancing of transparency with privacy ensures that their interactions with AI are safer and more accountable.	individuals from companies or authorities are recorded. This ensures accountability and transparency, particularly in employment-related AI systems like performance tracking or recruitment algorithms. However, workers might be concerned about privacy if personal information is involved in the registration process. Ensuring that only essential data is collected and protecting the identities of workers involved in the deployment or management of AI systems minimizes risk. The database helps workers trace accountability while maintaining necessary privacy	information for legal representatives, during the registration of their AI systems. While this ensures compliance and facilitates communication between businesses and regulatory bodies, it also places a responsibility on companies to protect this data from misuse. Businesses must ensure that the personal information shared is appropriately secured and that they comply with data protection regulations. The restriction of personal data usage to what's necessary minimizes legal risks for companies, ensuring that they	ensuring that only necessary details are collected and protected. While governments may need to store and access contact information for those managing or deploying AI systems, the focus is on safeguarding individual privacy. By limiting personal data collection, governments uphold the European Union's data protection standards, such as GDPR. This ensures that citizens and organizations participating in the AI database aren't subject to unnecessary privacy invasions. Governments must also ensure that personal data is used solely for operational purposes related	maintaining accountability, it is crucial that these records are not misused, especially for vulnerable groups. The restriction of personal data collection to the essential contact details of responsible parties prevents potential exploitation. However, any misuse or over-collection could disproportionately affect marginalized groups, especially if AI systems related to law enforcement, welfare, or healthcare impact them. The database's design ensures that personal data is not used to profile or harm minorities, thus contributing to a more ethical and	collecting what is necessary for the effective functioning of the system. This safeguards individual privacy and prevents misuse of personal information. The restriction of data usage is reassuring, as the public can trust that their personal details won't be exploited without consent. The public benefits from this by knowing that their information won't be part of an AI database unless it directly contributes to accountability and transparency in AI deployment. It reinforces the principles of data protection while enabling informed oversight of AI technologies.
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			protections to prevent misuse of their personal information.	contribute to transparency without overexposing sensitive personnel details or organizational information.	to AI system oversight.	responsible AI landscape for all.	
Commission Responsibility and Support	The European Commission will act as the data controller and ensure the database meets accessibility standards. It will also offer technical and administrative support to providers and deployers, facilitating compliance and smooth operation of the registration system.	For consumers, the Commission's role in managing the EU AI database ensures that the information remains accurate, up-to-date, and accessible. The Commission provides technical and administrative support, which guarantees that the system is user-friendly and navigable for consumers seeking information on AI systems. As the controller of the database, the Commission is accountable for overseeing how AI systems are registered and	For workers, the Commission's oversight ensures that AI systems used in employment contexts are properly registered, reviewed, and accessible in the EU database. The Commission is responsible for ensuring compliance with regulations, which helps guarantee that employers can't deploy unregulated or harmful AI systems, especially in areas like performance evaluation or recruitment. Additionally, the	For businesses, the Commission's responsibility in managing the database provides clear guidelines for compliance. The Commission not only facilitates the registration process but also offers technical and administrative support to businesses, helping them navigate the database's requirements. Businesses can rely on the Commission to maintain the system, ensuring that it operates efficiently and remains accessible.	Governments benefit from the Commission's oversight of the AI database because it ensures uniformity and consistency across member states. The Commission's role in managing the database also means that governments can rely on a central entity to handle the technicalities of registration, compliance, and support. This centralized control reduces the administrative burden on individual member states, making it easier for them to enforce AI	For minorities, the Commission's oversight ensures that AI systems are deployed transparently and ethically. As the Commission manages the database and provides support, it plays a pivotal role in safeguarding against discriminatory practices in AI systems, especially those affecting vulnerable groups. The Commission's role in monitoring the registry helps prevent the widespread use of biased or harmful algorithms in sectors like	The Commission's responsibility for overseeing and managing the AI database directly benefits the general public by ensuring that the database is accurate, reliable, and accessible. As the regulatory authority, the Commission ensures that data on AI systems is presented in a user-friendly manner, which promotes public awareness and participation in discussions around AI. The Commission's technical and administrative support helps



		how data is shared, creating a trusted environment for consumers. This oversight ensures that AI systems that impact consumer lives meet established safety standards and that consumers can access trustworthy information about these systems.	Commission's support ensures that there are channels through which workers can raise concerns or request audits of AI systems affecting their work. This creates a mechanism for worker advocacy, as well as a form of protection against exploitative or biased AI applications in the workplace.	Additionally, the Commission's oversight reassures businesses that AI systems registered in the database are compliant with European regulations, protecting companies from legal risks and encouraging them to adopt transparent, ethical AI practices. The support offered helps businesses align with EU AI standards and promotes regulatory clarity.	regulations. Furthermore, the Commission's responsibility for updating and maintaining the database enables governments to track AI deployments, ensuring that both private and public sector AI systems meet the regulatory standards and safeguards established by the EU.	housing, policing, or healthcare. This oversight offers minorities a form of protection, ensuring that AI systems deployed by public and private entities do not disproportionately harm marginalized communities. The Commission's accountability ensures that AI remains equitable and just for all.	maintain the integrity of the system, ensuring transparency in how AI systems are deployed across various sectors. This oversight provides the public with confidence that AI technologies are being used responsibly, fostering trust and encouraging greater civic engagement in AI governance.
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Calls to
action



Implement Strong Data Protection Measures

Establish strict data protection measures to ensure that only essential personal data is collected and processed for the EU AI database registration. Follow GDPR guidelines rigorously to ensure the privacy and security of personal data, such as contact details for responsible individuals, and implement internal data protection policies to safeguard sensitive information.



Train Employees on Data Privacy Compliance

Provide training programs for employees involved in the registration and management of AI systems to ensure compliance with data protection regulations. This includes educating staff about the importance of collecting only necessary data and safeguarding personal information to prevent any violations of privacy laws or breaches.



Establish Direct Communication with the Commission

Establish a clear line of communication with the European Commission to ensure you stay up-to-date on regulations and changes. Regularly engage with the Commission to clarify any regulatory requirements or address any compliance concerns. This will help ensure your business is proactive in meeting regulatory demands and receiving the necessary support for compliance.



Leverage Commission Support for Compliance

Take advantage of the Commission's technical and administrative support services to ensure your AI systems are compliant with EU regulations. Use available resources for troubleshooting, understanding complex requirements, or getting guidance on database registration processes. This will streamline your company's compliance efforts and ensure your AI systems meet EU standards efficiently.





Conclusion

The EU Database for High-Risk AI Systems marks a significant shift toward proactive regulation of AI technologies, ensuring transparency and accountability in AI deployment. By requiring AI systems—especially those deemed high-risk—to be registered, the database acts as a powerful mechanism to prevent the use of harmful AI applications that could threaten privacy, fairness, and human rights. This shift from reactive enforcement to pre-emptive monitoring creates a clear legal framework that helps protect individuals from potentially exploitative AI systems.

Throughout this report, we have highlighted how the EU AI Database plays a central role in managing AI system lifecycles, with an emphasis on transparency, ethical design, and continuous monitoring. Ensuring compliance with registration requirements allows organizations to demonstrate accountability, safeguard public trust, and avoid reputational harm or legal penalties. By maintaining up-to-date, accessible information about high-risk AI systems, the database supports the development of AI technologies that align with safety and human rights standards.

For successful integration, organizations must establish governance structures that embed compliance with the database's requirements throughout the AI system lifecycle. Smaller providers may need additional training and sector-specific guidance to ensure smooth registration and adherence to transparency standards. However, embracing these responsibilities not only reduces compliance risks but also promotes the development of trustworthy, ethically designed AI.

As AI adoption continues to grow across sectors, the EU Database for High-Risk AI Systems provides an essential framework for protecting citizens while encouraging responsible innovation. Adhering to the database's standards will set a global example for safe, rights-respecting AI governance, ensuring that AI systems operate transparently and ethically in all contexts.





Appendix B: Expert Vignette



Maria Flores

*Global Data &
Privacy Leader*



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The EU Data Strategy reflects Europe’s humanist values, promoting trust, infrastructure, and SME growth, but complex regulations, data quality, trade secrets, and uneven national maturity could hinder consistent implementation across the Union.

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Biography

Maria Flores is a multilingual Global Data Protection, Privacy, and AI Governance Lead with extensive experience from supporting startups to multinational organisations in building and strengthening responsible data and AI frameworks. She has led global privacy and AI governance programmes, managed cross-border compliance, and advised on digital transformation projects across Europe, the United States, and other international markets. Her work focuses on translating complex legal and ethical requirements into practical, business-driven strategies that foster innovation, trust, and accountability. With a background spanning business, law, cybersecurity, and IT, she brings strategic insight and operational expertise to privacy data protection and AI leadership.



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